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price starting at
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turbo charged 163 ps with 280Nm torque
dual openR screens with Google built-in
7-year warranty

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Renault recommends Castrol



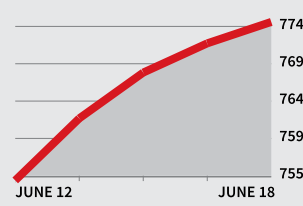
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CLEAR FOCUS. Will continue to build a more agile institution with strength of tech, relationships: Chairman Setty

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IN FOCUS

	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	24168.00	+82.30
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	20.92	+0.07
US Dollar (in ₹)	94.33	-0.19
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	147500.00	-2047
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	240191.00	-7497

GOING DRY.

Mumbai and Pune await South-West monsoon as water reserves continue to dwindle amid delay in seasonal rain **p8**



SELF-APPRAISAL.

Technology solutions firm Coempt Edu Teck says it is not at fault in the CBSE OSM case **p10**

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N. Murali appointed Chairman of The Hindu Group Publishing Private Limited

N Murali has been unanimously appointed Chairman of the Board of Directors of The Hindu Group Publishing Private Limited (THGPPL) for a term of three years. He succeeds Dr Nirmala Lakshman, who stepped down as Chairperson at the Board's meeting on Thursday, June 18, 2026, upon nearing the completion of her three-year term. The Nomination and Remuneration Committee of the Board, chaired by Mr Krishna Srinivasan, Senior Advocate, unanimously recommended appointment of Mr Murali to lead the Board at this challenging time for the news media and for professional journalism.

Mr Murali brings to his responsibility more than 56 years of hands-on experience on the management, business, and financial side of the newspaper industry.

After completing his school education at the Madras Christian College High School, graduating in Commerce from Loyola College, Chennai, and professionally qualifying as a Chartered Accountant, he joined the family business of *The Hindu* in 1969. He became General Manager in 1977 and Joint Managing Director in 1995. In 2006, he took over as Managing Director of M/s Kasturi & Sons Limited, publishers of *The Hindu* and other allied publications, including *The Hindu Business-Line*. He subsequently served as Chairman, Kasturi & Sons Limited (the holding company of The Hindu group of publications).

Over the last several years, he has been a Director of THGPPL and KSL.

Over the decades, Mr Murali has served in senior positions in a number of industry bodies: He was President of the Indian Newspaper Society (INS); Chairman, Council of Management, Audit Bureau of Circulations; Chairman, National Readership Studies Council; Chairman, Board of Governors, Advertising Standards Council of India; and Chairman, Board of Trustees of the Press Institute of India - RIND. He was elected as the first Board Member from South Asia of the world's leading association for media publishing, IFRA, Darmstadt, Germany (1998-2004), and served as a Member of the Board of the World Association of Newspapers (WAN), Paris (2005-2006). He is a Trustee of the Media Development Foundation, Chennai, which administers the Asian College of Journalism (ACJ).

He is the President of The Music Academy, Madras. The Board of Directors of The Hindu Group Publishing Private Limited placed on record its appreciation of Dr Nirmala Lakshman's contributions to the Group and its publications and the efficient way in which she led the deliberations and proceedings at the Board level.

Board members and employees expressed enthusiasm and confidence that Mr Murali, with his rich experience and perspectives gained in a field that has witnessed many successes, undergone a series of disruptive transformations, and repeatedly demonstrated resilience and relevance, will lead the company to new heights.

Trump's Iran deal extends ceasefire, opens Hormuz

NEW ERA. Complex 60-day negotiating period over Tehran's nuclear programme begins

Bloomberg

US President Donald Trump formally agreed to an interim peace deal with Iran, shifting focus to the planned reopening of the Strait of Hormuz and a complex 60-day negotiating period over Tehran's nuclear programme.

Trump signed the so-called memorandum of understanding at the Palace of Versailles near Paris on Wednesday evening, at the end of a Group of Seven summit.

He was flanked by world and business leaders, including French President Emmanuel Macron and Blackstone Inc Chief Executive Officer Steve Schwarzman, who applauded as he did so.

"Oil down," Trump immediately said, emphasising why he has been so keen to end a war with Iran he started alongside Israel at the end of February. The conflict and Iran's closure of the critical waterway caused energy prices to soar, and led to chaos across West Asia.

TO AVOID DEPRESSION Trump said further military conflict "could have caused an international depression". Those concerns led him to accept an agreement many Iran hawks in the US, as well as Israel, say concedes far too much to the Islamic Republic in terms of sanctions relief and potentially unfreezing tens of billions of dollars of funds.

"History teaches us giving



HISTORIC DAY. US President Donald Trump signs the Iran Memorandum of Understanding in France **p11**

billions of dollars to theatrical lunatics who want to murder us is not a good idea," said Senator Ted Cruz, a Texas Republican who is normally supportive of Trump's policies.

While ships weren't moving *en masse* through the Strait of Hormuz as of Thursday morning, some appeared to sail through. Three Saudi Arabian supertankers that had been stuck inside the Persian Gulf were recorded as being in the Gulf of Oman, on the other side of the chokepoint.

That represents the first large volumes, around 6 million barrels, of Saudi oil to cross the strait since the war began more than three months ago.

CLARITY NEEDED Many shipping and oil executives have said they need more clarity, including on whether the Strait is clear of mines and whether they

need to seek any kind of permission from Iran before sailing through. Iran will arrange passage of commercial ships through the strait with "no charge for 60 days only", according to a copy of the memorandum of understanding published by Iran's President Masoud Pezeshkian on X on Thursday.

Traffic "will be instated within 30 days," taking into account technical and military obstacles and the removal of mines by Iran, according to the MoU.

IRAN-OMAN TALKS Iran will hold talks with Oman to define the future administration and maritime services of the Strait of Hormuz, which will be in line with "applicable international law and the sovereign rights of coastal states" of the Persian Gulf, according to the agreement.

The US, Europe and Gulf Arab states have balked at

the idea of Iran charging a toll for what's widely considered international waters.

Oil fell further on Thursday, with Brent dropping to \$77.91 a barrel. It's down from close to \$95 since Trump said late last week that a deal was imminent.

Still, oil remains roughly 30 per cent higher for the year, with energy traders saying it will take months, if not longer, for volumes of oil and liquefied natural gas going through Hormuz to return to normal.

US Vice-President JD Vance and Iranian Parliament Speaker Mohammad Bagher Ghalibaf, Iran's lead negotiator, are scheduled to meet in Switzerland on Friday for a ceremony to mark the signing and start a further round of negotiations to permanently end the war.

The MoU extends a US-Iran ceasefire that began in April by 60 days. During that time, the sides will try to agree restrictions on Tehran's nuclear program and how to dilute or destroy its stocks of highly enriched uranium. Many nuclear experts say 60 days is too little to negotiate something so complex and technical, and the MoU says the timeframe can be extended.

The 2015 nuclear deal, which Trump abandoned during his first term, took about two years to finalise. Israel and the US said the conflict was necessary to prevent Iran acquiring atomic weapons.

UK to grant India higher country-specific, residual export quotas for steel

Amity Sen
New Delhi



The UK has agreed to grant India enhanced tariff-free export of steel through country-specific and residual steel import quotas, alongside access to its authorised use scheme (AUS), resolving a major sticking point in the bilateral free trade negotiations, said an official.

The breakthrough effectively shields Indian steel trade from severe disruptions as Britain's tighter steel safeguard measures take effect on July 1. Country-specific quotas provide individual countries with dedicated steel export quotas, while residual quotas offer additional access through shared pools open to all exporters. The AUS provides a further route for eligible steel products imported for specified industrial uses.

"The new safeguard regime is estimated to affect around 15 per cent of India's steel exports to the UK, worth about \$137 million a year. The rest of the \$1 billion of total steel exports [85 per cent of total steel exported to UK] are not affected by the safeguards," said an official tracking the matter.

There is, however, no understanding yet on the impact of the UK's proposed Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism (CBAM) levies, expected to be imposed from January 2027.

Discussions on the issue will take place once London finalises the framework, the official pointed out. "The UK

will impose carbon levy on the lines of EU from 2027. Even the 85 per cent 'protected' volumes under the CETA steel deal could face indirect pressure from CBAM costs. The two policies together create a dual challenge for UK market access," said Ajay Srivastava from research body GTRI.

While interests of the MSME steel sector, which had called for special carve-outs for six steel product categories, including hot-rolled steel sheets and strips and a variety of rods, bars and pipes, were given priority in the negotiations, the final deal was drafted within the "realm of reality", said the official.

India had put the India-UK comprehensive economic and trade agreement — signed in July 2025 — on hold when London announced its new safeguard measures to be implemented from July 1, 2026. Under the new regime, tariff free import quotas are to be slashed, while duties on shipments exceeding the quota are to be near-doubled to 50 per cent.

However, after the two countries reached a resolution on June 17, an announcement was made on the implementation of the India-UK CETA on July 15.

See also **p3**

NSE IPO set to deliver windfall returns for legacy shareholders

Akshata Gorde
Suresh P Iyengar
Mumbai

Half of the National Stock Exchange's (NSE's) oldest institutional investors are set to unlock sizeable gains through the exchange's proposed initial public offering (IPO), with the draft prospectus showing that many acquired their shares at weighted average costs well below the ₹1 face value after decades of holding the stock.

At a market-estimated offer-for-sale (OFS) price of around ₹2,100 per share, investors are poised to monetise their holdings for anywhere between ₹1,250 crore and ₹5,000 crore.

LARGEST SELLER

The largest seller in the IPO, the State Bank of India (SBI), is offering up to 2.48 crore shares of the 7.98 crore shares (3.23 per cent stake) it holds at a weighted average cost of ₹0.80 per share.

At the indicative price, the SBI's proposed sale alone would be worth over ₹5,000 crore. Bank of Baroda acquired NSE's shares at ₹0.54 a piece while for the Stock Holding Corporation of India, the weighted average acquisition cost was ₹0.46.

Both are offering 1.09 crore and 1.08 crore shares for sale, respectively, translating into potential proceeds of about ₹2,300 crore each at the estimated price.

Among other public sector undertakings (PSUs), New India Assurance Company and National Insurance Company each hold shares

Shareholding pattern

Shareholder	Shares offered	Weighted avg acquisition cost/share	Acquisition cost of shares offered#	Gains* #
State Bank of India	2.48	0.8	1.98	5,196
MS Strategic (Mauritius)	1.60	66.54	106.46	3,254
Canada Pension Plan Investment Board	1.19	324.13	384.74	2,108
Aranda Investments (Mauritius) Pte.	1.13	62.38	70.18	2,292
Bank of Baroda	1.10	0.54	0.59	2,307
Stock Holding Corporation of India	1.09	0.46	0.50	2,286
General Insurance Corporation of India	1.07	5.26	5.61	2,233
The New India Assurance Company	1.05	0.32	0.34	2,205
National Insurance Company	0.60	0.32	0.19	1,260
United India Insurance Company	0.60	0.50	0.30	1,260

Source: Draft prospect; * estimated offer price @₹2100/share; #in ₹ crore; Shares offered in crore; average cost/share in ₹

acquired at ₹0.32 apiece, while United India Insurance's acquisition cost is ₹0.50 per share. GIC Re's acquisition cost stands at ₹5.26 per share. These investors could realise proceeds ranging from about ₹1,260 crore to ₹2,300 crore, depending on the size of their stake sales.

The NSE had also issued bonus shares in a 4:1 ratio in November 2024, which effectively reduced the weighted average acquisition cost per share.

GAINS FOR FPIS, TOO

Foreign investors that entered at a later stage with relatively higher acquisition costs will pocket around ₹2,300 crore to ₹3,250 crore. MS Strategic (Mauritius) Ltd, Aranda Investments (Mauritius) Pte Ltd and

Canada Pension Plan Investment Board have weighted average acquisition costs of ₹66.54, ₹62.38 and ₹324.13 per share, respectively.

ONLY OFS ISSUE

The proposed IPO is entirely an OFS of 14.89 crore shares, or nearly 6 per cent of the NSE's paid-up capital, with no fresh issue, meaning the exchange itself will not receive any proceeds.

Based on the market-estimated price, the total OFS size could exceed ₹30,000 crore, making it one of India's largest public offerings.

The last IPO that came close to this size was of Hyundai Motor India, which raised nearly ₹28,000 crore through its IPO in 2024, and LIC before that, which raised ₹21,000 crore in 2022.

See also **p6**

Ban on Telegram very justifiable, govt tells court

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

Counsel representing the Centre on Thursday told the Delhi High Court that the ban on Telegram was very much justifiable because lakhs of students are impacted, and it was not a permanent blocking of the app, but just for a few days till the NEET-UG 2026 re-examination.

The Centre strongly argued before the High Court that Telegram had all the potential of getting misused by miscreants.

Justice Tejas Karia reserved the verdict after hearing extensive arguments from Senior Advocate Dhruv Mehta, appearing for Telegram, and Attorney General R Venkataramani and Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, who represented the Centre.

Details on **p10**

PARIS SHOWCASE



EIFEL MOMENT. France's President Emmanuel Macron holds a replica of the Eiffel Tower as Lebanon's Prime Minister Nawaf Salam stands beside him at the Viva Technology (VivaTech) trade fair in Paris on Thursday **REUTERS**

Citing wetland damage, TN may shelve Parandur airport

Our Bureau
Chennai

The Tamil Nadu government is unlikely to proceed with the greenfield airport plan at Parandur as it involves the destruction of wetlands.

ANOTHER SITE

Instead, the State will explore an alternative site for the project, said State Minister for Energy, Resources and Law Nirmal Kumar on

Thursday. Speaking to reporters at the Secretariat after the Governor's address, the Minister reiterated the government's opposition to the Parandur airport project in its current form.

"Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay's first ground protest was against the greenfield airport at Parandur. We remain firm on our stand. We are not against development, but we will not destroy wetlands," he said.

The statement marks a

significant shift from the previous government's approach to the project.

RETHINK ON INFRA

With the State government now indicating that it will look for an alternative location, the timeline and contours of Tamil Nadu's long-term aviation infrastructure expansion are likely to be reassessed.

The previous DMK administration had accelerated land acquisition for the pro-

posed airport in Kancheepuram district and secured over 2,500 acres of the 5,746 acres required.

Compensation packages offered to landowners were substantially higher than the prevailing market rates.

The future of the second airport assumes importance as passenger traffic at Chennai airport continues to grow rapidly.

The existing airport handles more than 2.2 crore passengers annually. Follow-

ing the completion of ongoing modernisation and expansion works, its capacity is expected to increase to 3.5 crore passengers a year.

AVIATION HUB

The Parandur airport was envisaged as a major aviation hub, with the capacity to handle up to 10 crore passengers annually. The plan included two runways, terminal buildings, taxiways, apron facilities and a dedicated cargo terminal.

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QUICKLY.

HDFC Bank extends
Keki Mistry's term



Mumbai: The search for a new part-time Chairman for HDFC Bank, India's largest private sector bank, just got longer. The bank's board, at its meeting held on Thursday, granted approval for the extension of Keki Mistry's tenure as an interim part-time Chairman for three months until September 18, or till the appointment of a regular Part-time Chairman, whichever is earlier. The aforementioned development comes even as the board approved convening of the 32nd AGM of the bank on August 5. According to banking experts, the bank may still be weighing its options for a suitable replacement for Atanu Chakraborty. The board is believed to be considering the names of RBI former Deputy Governor M Rajeshwar Rao and former Secretary of the Department of Financial Services M Nagaraju as PT Chairman. **OUR BUREAU**

UK social security exemption to save Indians \$500 million a year

TRADE BOOST. Benefit to apply on prospective basis from July 15, will not cover Indians working for foreign firms in UK

Amiti Sen
New Delhi



TOP GAINERS. The biggest beneficiaries are likely to be Indian companies that regularly send employees to the UK on temporary assignments, especially in the IT and ICT sectors **REUTERS**

The India-UK Double Contribution Convention (DCC), set to take effect on July 15 alongside the bilateral Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement (CETA), is expected to save Indian companies and their employees more than \$500 million annually by exempting eligible professionals working temporarily in the UK from making social security contributions there for up to five years, an official said.

The exemption, which will benefit about 75,000 Indian professionals, will not be extended to Indians working for other foreign companies in Britain.

"The new agreement will be on prospective basis. It will cover Indian employees of Indian companies working in the UK who are already

contributing to social security in India. This will ensure that there is no dual contribution," the official clarified.

SOCIAL SECURITY

The Indian companies and employees will have to share certificates of social security coverage in the home country to gain exemptions in the UK under the DCC. As most short-term workers are unable to qualify for social security benefits in the UK, where entitlement generally requires around 10 years of

contributions, the pact addresses a long-standing concern of Indian industry by preventing mandatory contributions that often yield no commensurate benefits, the official said.

The biggest beneficiaries are likely to be Indian companies that regularly send employees to the UK on temporary assignments, especially in IT and ICT sectors. These include companies such as Tata Consultancy Services, Infosys, Wipro, HCLTech and Tech

Mahindra. Explaining the expected savings of over \$500 million for companies annually, the official noted that the average annual salary of a professional in the UK is estimated at GBP 40,000-50,000, of which about 15 per cent of the salary is paid towards social security contributions.

"More than 75,000 Indian professionals and over 900 companies are expected to benefit. The agreement will support mobility and continued social security coverage

of the employees on temporary overseas assignments. This will enhance India-UK partnerships in the service sector, leveraging the high skills and innovative service sectors of both countries," according to a statement from the Commerce Department.

BUSINESS SUPPORT

The DCC will support business and trade by ensuring that employees moving between the UK and India, and their employers, will only be liable to pay social security contributions in one country at a time, according to the UK government.

"The DCC will also ensure that employees temporarily working in the other country will continue paying social security contributions in their home country, preventing the fragmentation of their social security record," the UK government posted on its website.

'FTA could open new avenues for automobile industry'

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

The automobile industry on Thursday said the implementation of India-UK Free Trade Agreement from next month is a landmark development that marks a significant step forward in strengthening India's global economic engagement with developed economies.

"Automobiles are an important pillar of this agreement and could open new avenues for collaboration and opportunities. SIAM remains committed to ensure the benefits of the agreement translate into greater growth, global competitiveness, and technological progress for the Indian automotive industry," Rajesh Menon, Director General, Society of Indian Automobile Manufacturers (SIAM), told *businessline*.

According to the India-UK Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement (CETA) document, released on Wednesday, India will get access to the UK's electric, hybrid/ hydrogen passenger cars segment with duty-free exports to that country from the sixth year in the price



DUTY RELIEF. Under the pact, tariffs on automotive imports will fall from about 110 per cent to 10 per cent, with quotas on both sides

segment ranging from £20,000 to £80,000, with the total quota reaching a peak of 88,000 units from the 15th year and continuing in the subsequent years.

This will benefit Indian manufacturers such as Tata Motors Passenger Vehicles, Mahindra & Mahindra, and Maruti Suzuki India, among others. As per the agreement, India will allow the import of 3.78 lakh units of conventional-engine passenger cars, including those in the mass segment, from

the UK at concessional customs duty during the first 15 years of the implementation of the trade pact between the two countries.

TARIFFS TO FALL

Under the pact, tariffs on automotive imports will fall from about 110 per cent to 10 per cent, with quotas on both sides.

"We believe India has the competitiveness to welcome liberalisation and use it for export opportunities... We have already started export-

ing eVitara to Europe with about 36,000 units already exported within 9 months of the launch and UK being the top market. Therefore, we believe this FTA will be positive for 'Make in India for the world,'" Rahul Bharti, Senior Executive Officer, Corporate Affairs at MSIL, said.

For imports from the UK to India, the quota for conventional-engine passenger cars will peak in the 15th year across specified categories of vehicles at 37,000 units, with customs duties reduction reaching a final 10 per cent. The duties will not be reduced beyond this.

In the first year, the quota for passenger cars of engine size more than 3,000 cc (petrol) and over 2,500 cc (diesel) is 10,000 units, with customs duty being reduced to 30 per cent from 110 per cent.

For cars with engine size of 1,500 cc (petrol), 2,500 cc (diesel) and 3,000 cc (petrol), the quota is 5,000 units, with duty being reduced to 50 per cent from 66 per cent.

In the mass market segment of engine size of up to 1,500 cc, the allowed quota of import in the first year of the pact is 5,000 units, with

customs duty being reduced to 50 per cent from 66 per cent, as per CETA.

A total of 20,000 units of passenger cars across the three categories will be allowed to be imported in the first year under the agreement.

Further, in the fifth year, the import quota for passenger cars of engine size more than 3,000 cc (petrol) and over 2,500 cc (diesel) is 19,000 units, while for cars with engine size of 1,500 cc (petrol), 2,500 cc (diesel) and 3,000 cc (petrol), the import quota is capped at 9,000 units, and a similar quota is fixed for cars with engine size of up to 1,500 cc at 10 per cent concessional duty.

From the 15th year, the total quota will remain constant at 15,000 units annually with duties fixed at 10 per cent across the three categories.

EXPORT OPPORTUNITIES

"The phased, quota-based framework creates a calibrated pathway by opening new export opportunities for Indian-made EVs in the UK while supporting long-term competitiveness of the domestic industry," a

spokesperson at Tata Motors Passenger Vehicles said.

Rajan Amba, Managing Director at JLR India, said this FTA will allow more clients to experience the highly desirable and aspirational SV portfolio, and further strengthen the JLR India growth story.

"All UK-built completely built units (CBUs) in our portfolio qualify — Range Rover SV, Range Rover Sport SV, plus Bespoke and limited-edition models," Amba said, adding that the company has recently announced pricing changes like Range Rover SV repriced from ₹4.25 crore to ₹3.5 crore and Range Rover Sport SV repriced from ₹2.75 crore to ₹2.35 crore.

UK trade pact to level the playing field for labour-intensive exports

Our Bureau
New Delhi



The India-UK Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement (CETA) is set to give a boost to key export sectors in India — many of them labour-intensive, such as textiles, footwear, leather, marine products, processed food, engineering goods, chemicals, and pharmaceutical items — as tariffs get eliminated in the UK market on July 15.

"A number of labour-intensive exporters, who suffered high tariffs in the UK and lost out to competitors benefitting from zero duties either from LDCs or countries that had free trade pacts with Britain, will now get a level playing field. They are expected to make big gains," an official said.

For instance, tariffs of up to 70 per cent on processed food products, up to 21.5 per cent on marine products, up to 18 per cent on engineering goods and auto components, up to 16 per cent on leather and footwear products, up to 12 per cent on textiles and clothing, and up to 8 per cent on chemicals and pharmaceutical products will be reduced to zero, the Commerce Department noted in a statement.

ZERO-DUTY ACCESS

The CETA provides zero-duty access on 99 per cent of India's exports to the UK, covering nearly 100 per cent of trade value.

India's textile and apparel exporters are optimistic of making significant gains as they would no longer have to face a duty handicap vis-à-vis competitors like Bangladesh in the "highly promising" UK market.

"The India-UK CETA will change that, providing us with a level-playing field so that our products can find more willing buyers as they can now be priced more attractively relative to competition. The agreement will enable our companies to significantly improve their market share not only in the top product categories of the UK's textile and apparel imports but across the broader textile and apparel segment as well," pointed out Ashwin Chandran, Chairman, Confederation of Indian Textile Industry.

CITI is working closely with industry and local authorities to ensure that Indian companies can effectively leverage opportunities opening through the India-UK CETA, he said.

"The immediate duty-free access secured under CETA is expected to significantly enhance the competitiveness of Indian exports in the UK market," the Commerce Department pointed out.

Indian consumers will get access to premium brands from UK at lower prices

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi



The pact opens up opportunities for brands to export processed foods and cosmetics to the UK **REUTERS**

With the India-UK FTA set to come into effect from July 15, Indian consumers will get access to a range of UK products at cheaper prices in categories such as alcobev, beauty products, baked goods, chocolates and soft beverages at cheaper prices.

Experts said that it also opens up opportunities for Indian brands to exports processed foods, wellness products and cosmetics to UK. At the same time, stakeholders are looking to gain more clarity on finer print details such as rules of origin and alignment in sanitary and phytosanitary norms as experts said robust compliance frameworks will be key.

Sagar Shah, Partner, Tax and Regulatory, EY India said the agreement is set to expand access to premium and specialty imported goods, making them more affordable to Indian consumers. "Nevertheless, while tariff liberalisation enhances market access, the realization of these benefits will be contingent upon robust compliance frameworks and alignment with India's regulatory ecosystem," he added.

COSMETICS SEGMENT

He said that in the cosmetics segment, while tariff reductions improve landed cost efficiencies, non-tariff barriers including the adherence to the compulsory compliance

requirements, labelling norms, and precise product classification will continue to play a critical role in ensuring seamless trade flow. "Accurate classification and compliance assessment of derma-category products will be critical to ensure correct tariff treatment and eligibility for FTA benefits along with other cosmetics product," Shah added.

"Indian consumers are actively seeking cutting-edge formulations. That makes UK brands a perfect fit for India, especially in the prestige segment, where demand for high-end, high-efficacy products is growing," said Radhika Ghai, Founder & CEO, kindlife.

In the processed food segment, the Indian market is expected to see entry of premium and specialty food products from the UK. Amit Lohani, Founder Director, Forum of Indian Food Importers, said, "Setting a clear implementation date for the India-UK FTA is a positive

step that brings certainty to businesses. We urge the policymakers to ensure the deal addresses sanitary and phytosanitary (SPS) alignment, transparent rules of origin that reflect real-world supply chains, and practical transitional arrangements for tariff phase-ins."

BEVERAGES

Naveen Malpani, Partner and Consumer Industry Leader, Grant Thornton Bharat, pointed out that for Indian companies, the agreement presents an opportunity to expand exports of processed foods, wellness products and natural or Ayurveda-inspired cosmetics to UK. He added that the agreement will reshape competitive dynamics across cosmetics, packaged foods and alcoholic beverages by improving market access and reducing trade barriers.

Meanwhile, the International Spirits and Wines Association of India said that reduced tariffs on Scotch whisky imports from the UK will enable Indian consumers get access to premium international brands at more accessible price points. "Importantly, the reduction in duties on bulk Scotch imports will also benefit India's domestic spirits industry by lowering input costs for bottling and blending operations, enabling manufacturers to enhance product quality and competitiveness," said Sanjit Padhi, CEO, ISWAI.

US-Iran peace deal to ease disruptions for Indian exporters

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Indian exporters have cheered the signing of the initial deal between US and Iran to end the war and open the Strait of Hormuz that would lead to restoration of normal traffic, eliminating long maritime detours.

"Exporters were previously crushed by exorbitant freight fees and prohibitive war-risk insurance premiums. Normalisation will slash these overheads, ensuring smoother, faster, and remarkably cheaper transit times to West Asia and European destinations," exporters' body FIEO said.

Lowering of fuel prices will also soften input costs for crude-dependent sectors such as plastics, paints and chemicals, it added.

MAJOR RELIEF

The immediate reopening of the Strait of Hormuz — through which roughly half of India's crude imports and a vast chunk of container traffic passes — is the single most significant relief for global supply chains, FIEO noted.

"The lifting of the US naval blockade and the restoration of normal traffic eliminate long maritime detours making our exports to the EU, US and West Africa much more competitive," it said.

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CIN:L85110KA1951PLC000761

NOTICE

(For the attention of Equity Shareholders of the Company)

Sub.: Transfer of Equity Shares of the Company to Investor Education and Protection Fund (IEPF) Authority

This notice is published pursuant to the provisions of the Investor Education and Protection Fund Authority (Accounting, Audit, Transfer and Refund) Rules, 2016, as amended ("the Rules").

Pursuant to Section 124(6) of the Companies Act, 2013 ("the Act") read with the Rules, the Company is mandated to transfer all shares in respect of which dividends have not been paid or claimed for seven consecutive years or more to Investor Education and Protection Fund Authority ("IEPF Authority" or "Authority").

In compliance with the requirements set out in the Rules, the Company has communicated individually to the concerned shareholders whose shares are liable to be transferred to IEPF Authority during the financial year 2026-27 for taking appropriate action(s).

The Company has also uploaded details of such shareholders whose shares are due for transfer to the Authority on its website at www.bosch.in under the Section "Shareholder Information".

The concerned shareholders, holding shares in physical form and whose shares are liable to be transferred to the Authority, may note that the Company would be issuing new share certificate(s) in lieu of the original share certificate(s) held by them for the purpose of transfer of shares to the Authority as per Rules and upon such issue, the original share certificate(s) which is registered in their name will stand automatically cancelled and be deemed non-negotiable. The shareholders may further note that the details uploaded by the Company on its website should be regarded as and shall be deemed adequate notice in respect of issue of new certificate(s) by the Company for the purpose of transfer of shares to the Authority, pursuant to the Rules.

In case of shares held in dematerialised form, the company shall inform the depository by way of corporate action, where the shareholders have their accounts for transfer in favour of the IEPF Authority.

Please note that the due date for claiming dividend for financial year 2018-19 is 26.09.2026. All concerned shareholders are requested to make an application to the company/ Company's Registrar to an Issue and Share Transfer Agent("ITA") by 19.09.2026 with a request for claiming un-encashed or unclaimed dividend for the year 2018-19 and onwards to enable processing of claims before the due date. In case no valid claim in respect of un-encashed or unclaimed dividend is received from the concerned shareholders, the Company shall, with a view to comply with the requirements set out in the Rules, transfer the said shares to the Authority as per procedure stipulated in the Rules.

The shareholders may please note that no claim lie against the Company in respect of shares transferred to the IEPF Authority. The Shareholders may also note that once the shares held by them and the unclaimed dividends are transferred to the IEPF, they will be entitled to claim their share(s) and the unclaimed dividend amount(s) including all corporate benefits accruing on such share(s), if any, from the IEPF Authority, by first sending physical copy of requisite documents to the Company duly signed by all the joint shareholders, if any, as per the specimen signature recorded with the Company for obtaining the entitlement letter, pursuant to Circular dated July 20, 2022 issued by IEPF Authority, and thereafter submitting an online application in Form IEPF-5 available on the website of the IEPF at <https://www.iepf.gov.in>, by following the procedure as detailed in the IEPF Rules.

In case the shareholders have any queries on the subject matter, they may contact the Company's Registrar and Share Transfer Agent viz. Integrated Registry Management Services Private Limited at No.30, Ramana Residency, 4th Cross, Sampige Road, Malleswaram, Bengaluru 560 003. Tel: (080) 23460815 to 818; Fax: (080) 234608 19. E-mail ID: irg@integratedindia.in

For Bosch Limited,
V. Srinivasan
Company Secretary & Compliance Officer

Place: Bengaluru
Date: 18.06.2026

Regulating tech platforms

RBI might be changing its perspective on the issue

Puneet Gupta
Siddharth Shekhar Singh

One of the most consequential developments in Indian finance today is Reserve Bank of India's growing examination of whether large digital platforms, e-commerce ecosystems, and embedded payment intermediaries should come under more direct financial regulation. The RBI appears increasingly focused not simply on who owns a banking licence, but on who controls financial behaviour at scale. That is an important distinction.

India's digital economy has evolved far beyond the early phase of standalone fintech applications. A growing share of financial activity no longer originates within a bank branch or even within a traditional banking interface. Instead, it originates inside platforms that consumers use daily for shopping, communication, transportation, subscriptions, and business operations.

ECONOMIC POWER

The regulated financial institution often remains in the background. The platform owns the customer relationship. This evolution has altered the distribution of economic power within the financial system. Historically, banks controlled deposits, underwriting, and transaction infrastructure. Today, platforms increasingly control user engagement, transaction flow, merchant access, behavioural data, and financial discovery. In many cases, the platform, not the bank, determines which payment methods consumers see, which financial products merchants access, and how economic interactions are orchestrated digitally. That level of influence inevitably attracts regulatory attention. The RBI's emerging posture mirrors a broader global trend. Regulators in the US and Europe have begun reassessing whether large technology ecosystems should remain outside prudential-style oversight simply because they are not banks in the traditional legal sense. Apple Pay, Google Pay, super-app ecosystems, and large embedded finance platforms are no longer viewed merely as software interfaces. Increasingly, they are seen as strategically important financial infrastructure.

The underlying concern is straightforward: systemic



TRANSACTIONS. A growing share originates in platforms

importance in the digital economy may arise from ecosystem control rather than balance-sheet size alone. This represents a major evolution in financial regulation.

In the industrial banking era, systemic risk came primarily from leverage, liquidity mismatches, and interconnected balance sheets. In the platform economy, risk can emerge through concentration of data, transaction dependency, operational centralisation, and ecosystem influence. A major outage, governance failure, cyber incident, or disruption at a dominant platform can affect millions of consumers and merchants simultaneously — even if the platform itself is not technically a bank. That changes the logic of supervision.

Ironically, this environment may strengthen traditional banks. For much of the past decade, incumbent financial institutions feared becoming commoditised infrastructure providers serving platform ecosystems that controlled customer engagement. But tighter oversight of platforms could rebalance that equation.

The RBI's evolving posture is likely to shape the next phase of global finance: the future regulatory perimeter will increasingly be defined by systemic influence rather than institutional labels. That transition carries profound implications. The most powerful companies in the digital economy are increasingly shaping economic behaviour itself. They influence how consumers transact, how merchants operate, how credit is distributed, how financial products are discovered, and how commercial ecosystems function digitally.

In many respects, platforms have become the new financial gateways. India now appears to be confronting this transition earlier than many expected.

Gupta is Professor, GIFT International FinTech Institute, and Singh is Professor of Marketing, Indian School of Business. Views are personal

Courts, spectrum and the State

NOT IN CONFLICT. Two court decisions this year reveal both the source and the limits of sovereign power over spectrum



RAJASEKHARA VK

In February this year, the Supreme Court delivered its judgment in the *Aircel* matter. The Court held that spectrum remains a sovereign resource held by the State in trust for the public and that the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code (IBC) cannot be used to treat spectrum as an asset available for resolution or liquidation merely because it appears as an intangible asset in a telecom company's books.

Four months later came the Bombay High Court's decision on the One-Time Spectrum Charge. There, the Court told the Government something very different. Whatever its powers over spectrum may be, those powers do not permit it to revisit concluded allocations years later and impose fresh financial burdens that were never part of the original bargain.

At first sight, the two decisions seem to pull in different directions. One emphasises sovereign control. The other emphasises the limits of sovereign power. But the apparent tension begins to dissolve when we ask a more basic question: what exactly was each court deciding?

The dispute before the Bombay High Court was about whether the government could retrospectively alter the financial terms on which spectrum had already been allocated. Telecom operators had been allotted spectrum. They paid the prescribed licence fees and built their businesses on the basis of those arrangements.

The controversy arose when the government sought to levy what came to be known as the One-Time Spectrum Charge. The charge was aimed at spectrum held beyond 6.2 MHz and was sought to be imposed retrospectively from 2008. It was founded on the view that operators holding spectrum beyond that threshold should pay an additional amount, calculated by reference to later-discovered market values and auction prices.

The operators challenged the demand. Their argument was simple. The original licence framework contained no such obligation. Spectrum had been allocated, consideration had been determined and the parties had acted on that basis for years. The government could not reopen a concluded arrangement and demand additional consideration long after the event.

The Bombay High Court's reasoning rested on a proposition that is fundamental to both public law and



RESTRICTED POWER. What a telecom operator receives is not ownership of the spectrum but a limited right to use it ISTOCK

commercial certainty. Even where the government acts in an area involving public resources, it cannot exercise its powers in a manner that is arbitrary, unpredictable or destructive of settled rights. A contractual arrangement cannot be transformed years later merely because the government has come to believe that a different bargain might have yielded greater revenue.

The judgment is therefore about the limits of executive power. The Court was not denying that spectrum is a valuable public resource. What is rejected was the notion that the sovereign character of the resource gave the government an unrestricted ability to rewrite the economic terms of a completed allocation.

THE AIRCEL DECISION

The question before the Supreme Court in *Aircel* was not whether the government could alter the financial terms of an existing licence. Nor was it concerned with retrospective changes. The dispute arose out of insolvency proceedings and required the Court to examine the relationship between telecom regulation and the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code.

A telecom company's most valuable asset is often its ability to provide telecom services. That ability, in turn,

Sovereign control over spectrum survives, but that sovereignty does not confer an unrestricted power to revisit concluded bargains

depends upon the spectrum assigned to it and the licences under which it operates. If those rights cannot survive insolvency, the value of the business may collapse and the prospects of a successful resolution may diminish significantly.

The Department of Telecommunications approached the matter differently. It argued that spectrum is not a commercial asset owned by the licensee. Spectrum is a natural resource held by the State in trust for the public. What a telecom operator receives is not ownership of the spectrum but a limited right to use it, subject to statutory and regulatory conditions. That right remains inseparably linked to the regulatory framework governing telecommunications.

The Court emphasised that spectrum does not cease to be a sovereign resource merely because it is used for commercial purposes. Nor does it become part of the insolvency estate simply because it is reflected as an intangible asset in the books of a telecom company. The rights of a telecom licensee are derived from, and remain subject to, the regulatory regime under which the licence was originally granted.

Viewed in that light, the Court concluded that the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code cannot be used as a mechanism to compel the transfer of spectrum rights independently of the statutory framework governing telecommunications.

The existence of insolvency proceedings does not displace the Government's authority over the allocation and use of spectrum.

Spectrum is not merely an economic resource. It is a public resource. Any private right in relation to spectrum exists only within the limits defined by law and by the terms on which the State permits its use.

THE COMMON THREAD

The two decisions together reveal both the source and the limits of sovereign power over spectrum. The significance of that distinction is particularly evident in the sovereign function argument that often surfaces in insolvency debates.

Aircel reaffirms that spectrum remains under governmental control and that a telecom operator acquires only a limited right to use it. The Bombay High Court, however, reminds us that sovereign control is not the same thing as unfettered discretion to alter the legal and economic incidents of a licence *after* rights have accrued and obligations have been performed.

The State may regulate, supervise and control the use of spectrum, but it must do so within the framework of rights and obligations that it has itself created.

Seen in that light, the two decisions are less in conflict than in conversation. One explains why the government possesses authority over spectrum. The other explains why that authority is not without limits.

Read together, they suggest that sovereign control over spectrum survives, but that sovereignty does not confer an unrestricted power to revisit concluded bargains. *Aircel* explains the source of that power. The Bombay High Court explains its limits.

The writer is a lawyer and former Judicial Member of the National Company Law Tribunal

thehindubusinessline.

TWENTY YEARS AGO TODAY.

June 19, 2006

States told to enact laws to promote petro hubs

The Government is mulling a slew of reform measures, including labour law flexibility and single-window clearances, for facilitating investments into the proposed big-ticket petro hubs called petroleum, chemicals and petrochemicals investment regions.

Online train reservation growth doubles

The Railways' initiative to sell tickets to passengers through the Web has caught on well. In May 2006, about 3.97 lakh passengers used the Net to book their tickets against 1.81 lakh in May 2005. The trend was reflected in 2005-06, with ticket sales through the IRCTC website registering over 100 per cent growth over the previous fiscal.

Shortage of pilots: AI to hire fresh graduates for training

In a bid to tide over the shortage of pilots, Air India will be shortly recruiting fresh science and engineering graduates to be trained as pilots. "The board of Air India has approved this, and we will shortly come out with a scheme," Mr V. Thulasidas, Chairman and Managing Director, Air India, said. These graduates will be trained at least for six months at flying institutes abroad.

Trump will ask US companies to make missiles in Europe

Andrea Palasciano
Samy Adghirni,
Donato Paolo Mancini
Josh Wingrove

President Donald Trump is planning on asking US defence companies to produce weapons under licence in Europe and Ukraine, according to officials familiar with the discussions. "They would like to be able to do it, we'll take a look at it," Trump told reporters on Wednesday when asked about the plans at the Group of Seven summit in Evian, France.

Ukraine needs air defence capabilities, in particular interceptor missiles to stop Russian ballistic missiles, which only the US can make. But with the US

having burned through stocks in Iran and the time required to boost production, Trump told allies he'd look into licensing possibilities, according to officials who spoke on the condition of anonymity.

"The specific licences in question will be discussed in detail among the participating countries," German Chancellor Friedrich Merz told reporters Wednesday. "This does indeed involve the granting of comprehensive licences by American companies to European manufacturers."

France's Emmanuel Macron confirmed that Trump "insisted on the mobilisation of the American defence industry and the capacity to supply such equipment." He was speaking at his



GUARDED. Licensing agreements REUTERS

closing news conference as G7 host.

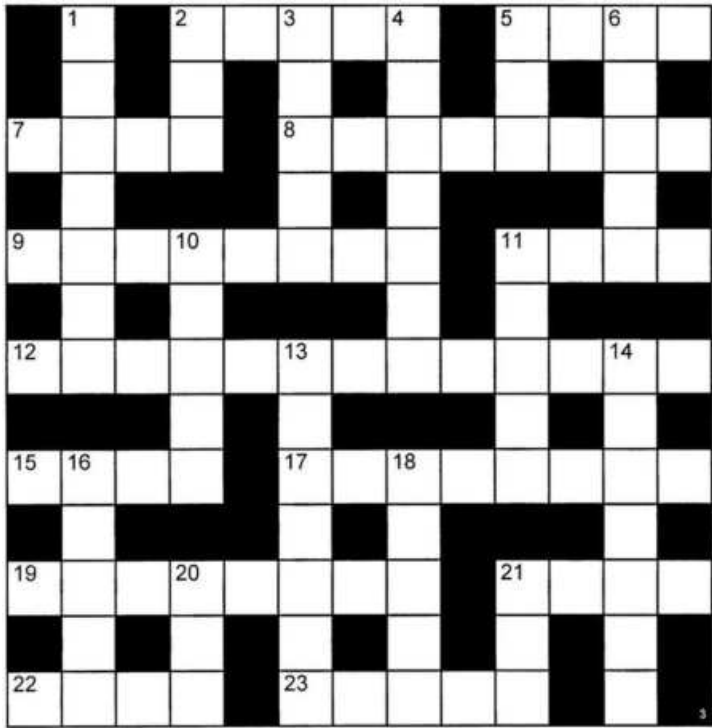
The US produces certain weapons under licence abroad, such as Patriot missiles in Germany, but generally guards its licensing agreements closely, due to intellectual property and supply chain concerns.

The US has continued to deliver air defence capabilities paid for by Europe and Canada through a NATO coordinated mechanism called PURL, despite concerns that the stocks may run low.

The G7 this week was considered a surprise success for Ukraine. Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy met with Trump and a positive joint statement was signed by all allies, including the US. Trump even expressed willingness to increase sanctions on Moscow.

"We all face the problem that we are currently producing too little — and this can be offset by granting licences to companies that have the necessary production capacity," Merz said. "These include both European and Ukrainian companies." BLOOMBERG

BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2675



EASY

ACROSS

- Bread, biscuit morsel (5)
- Grape-derived drink (4)
- Read superficially (4)
- They play together (8)
- Troubled, upset (8)
- Old huntsman's halloo (4)
- In similar unfavourable circumstances (2,3,4,4)
- Egyptian deity (4)
- The farthest removed (8)
- Shoes, boots, slippers etc (8)
- Superficial attractiveness (4)
- Spilled liquid (4)
- Public bath, hot bath (5)

DOWN

- Not within one's knowledge (7)
- Irregular projection on revolving shaft (3)
- Top part of shoe (5)
- Ennui (7)
- Be victorious (3)
- Toward the Arctic (5)
- Vertical drops containing fences (2-3)
- Wooden work-shoe (5)
- A glut (7)
- King David's favourite son (7)
- To mar (5)
- Cause to coalesce (5)
- Gratuity (3)
- Eucalyptus tree (3)

SOLUTION: BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2674

ACROSS 1. Scotland Yard 8. Marinade 9. Stem 11. Siege 12. Caution 13. Alto 15. Belt 19. Dominie 20. Extra 22. Reel 23. Kangaroo 24. Board of Trade

DOWN 2. Carve 3. Tender 4. Antics 5. Astride 6. Demonstrator 7. Smash and grab 10. Bun 14. Tempera 16. Any 17. Behalf 18. Ledger 21. Tired

NOT SO EASY

ACROSS

- A morsel of the soft part of bread (5)
- Drink we are about to have at home (4)
- Remove the top of the mask I must hold (4)
- A bit North and South about hesitation, or maybe East and West (8)
- Agitated by the one and the other deer that turns (8)
- A London district soon halved: oh, it will make a comeback (4)
- Like an eight find themselves sharing unfortunate experience (2,3,4,4)
- Is repeatedly seen in the Thames at Oxford (4)
- Not he least idea of it being the farthest away (8)
- Wrote of a change of boots (8)
- It doesn't sound innocent, this coat of gold (4)
- Propitiatory gift, about a litre of which will spill over (4)
- Article the Leathernecks take to be a heating unit (5)

DOWN

- The X factor, perhaps, one is stranger to (7)
- Projection on shaft turning up in machine (3)
- This the crust of first-class snobs (5)
- Tedium arising in a fashion to steal from one (7)
- Be successful in following Welsh leader (3)
- Direction given in Latin or Thai (5)
- Fences in ditches constructed by a Shah (2-3)
- Wooden shoe would take an age to damage the war effort (5)
- Too much of it to fit: sure needs altering (7)
- So a lamb was exchanged for a son of David (7)
- Plunder one found in 22 somehow (5)
- Blend in with Reg and me like this (5)
- A useful hint was to leave it under the plate (3)
- An adhesive that will hold teeth (3)

QUICKLY.

Iran deal optimism lifts Wall St over Fed worry



US stocks rebounded on Thursday with semiconductor shares leading gains as optimism about a West Asia peace deal offset worries about a hawkish Federal Reserve under new Chair Kevin Warsh. Intel's shares jumped almost 10 per cent after US President Donald Trump said Apple had agreed to work with the company to design and manufacture its chips in the US. Other chip stocks also moved higher. Nvidia rose 1.1 per cent, while Micron and Marvell Technology added over 5 per cent each. At 9.36 am ET, the Dow Jones Industrial Average rose 357.37 points to 51,853.59, the S&P 500 gained 62.05 points to 7,482.15 and the Nasdaq Composite gained 225.57 points to 26,247.23. REUTERS

HDFC arms pay ₹26 lakh to settle with SEBI

New Delhi: HDFC Property Fund and HDFC Capital Advisors have settled a case concerning a violation of venture fund regulation with SEBI after paying ₹26 lakh. The case pertains to the alleged delay in completing the process of asset liquidation and distribution of proceeds. There was a delay in winding up the schemes which is non-compliant with SEBI's Venture Capital Funds rules. According to the settlement order, HDFC Property Fund and HDFC Capital Advisors filed suo motu settlement applications with the regulator by "neither admitting nor denying the findings of facts and conclusions of law". PTI

Apex court to hear SEBI's plea against SAT relief to SICCL managers

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Thursday agreed to hear SEBI's plea challenging a part of the Securities Appellate Tribunal (SAT) order granting relief to four managers and the company secretary of Sahara India Commercial Corporation (SICCL). A Bench of Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justice V Mohana tagged the matter with pending petitions and listed it for July.

On March 9, the tribunal upheld regulatory action by the SEBI against SICCL and dismissed appeals filed by the company and its directors in connection with the alleged illegal issuance of optionally fully convertible debentures (OFCDs).

SAT RULING
The three-member SAT Bench ruled that the OFCDs issued by SICCL between 1998 and 2008 constituted a

FILA Group sells 7% in DOMS Ind for ₹934 crore

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

Italian multinational FILA Group, one of the promoters of DOMS Industries, has divested a 7 per cent stake in the company for ₹934 crore through open market transactions, according to the bulk deal data on the NSE. SBI MF and Axis MF have increased their holdings in DOMS Industries by purchasing a combined stake of 2.13 per cent for ₹285 crore. FILA offloaded over 42.48 lakh shares in two tranches, representing a 7 per cent stake in DOMS Industries, as per data on the NSE. The shares were sold in the price range of ₹2,200.07-2,200.55 apiece on Wednesday. FILA Group's shareholding in DOMS Industries has come down to 19.01 per cent from 26.01 per cent.

NSE DRHP flags uncertainty over pending co-location, dark fibre cases

IMPORTANT CASES. ₹1,491-crore co-location, dark fibre settlement proposals await SEBI clearance

Akshata Gorda
Mumbai

The National Stock Exchange (NSE) has cautioned investors that the outcome of several regulatory proceedings and court cases remains uncertain, with settlement proposals worth ₹1,491.21 crore in the long-running co-location and dark fibre matters still awaiting approval from SEBI.

In its draft red herring prospectus (DRHP), the exchange said it has recognised a ₹1,391.21-crore provision during FY26 towards the proposed settlement after revising the settlement terms submitted to the regulator in March.

The co-location matter dates back to 2015, when allegations first emerged that certain brokers received

preferential access to NSE's co-location facility, allowing them to connect to the exchange's trading servers ahead of other market participants. The dark fibre matter arose from the same broader investigation and relates to allegations that certain brokers received unfair access through dark fibre connectivity. NSE challenged SEBI's findings in both matters.

LONG LIST OF CASES

In August 2023, SAT set aside SEBI's disgorgement direction in the co-location matter and instead directed NSE to transfer ₹100 crore to the Investor Protection and Education Fund.

SAT had similarly set aside the dark fibre case orders. SEBI challenged both rulings before the Supreme Court, where the matters still re-



LEGAL ISSUES. The DRHP disclosed 18 criminal, 21 material civil, 43 tax and six statutory and regulatory proceedings against the exchange REUTERS

main pending. "The settlement applications are pending for final disposal with SEBI, the future outcome of which is uncertain at this stage," the exchange said in the risk factors section of the DRHP.

Other pending regulatory matters include SEBI's appeal before the Supreme Court against a SAT order

that set aside a ₹6-crore penalty imposed on NSE and its clearing corporation over some investments. Separately, NSE's appeal against SEBI's ₹2-crore penalty in the Karvy Stock Broking matter is pending before SAT, which has stayed the operation of the regulator's order.

A long-running competi-

tion law dispute with Metropolitan Stock Exchange of India (MSEI), where NSE's appeal against the ₹55.5-crore penalty imposed by the Competition Commission of India is pending before the Supreme Court. Separately, MSEI's compensation claim of ₹856.99 crore before the National Company Law Appellate Tribunal has been stayed, pending the outcome of the apex court proceedings.

In total, the DRHP disclosed 18 criminal proceedings, 21 material civil proceedings, 43 tax proceedings and six statutory and regulatory proceedings against the exchange.

The aggregate amount involved in proceedings against the company stands at ₹2,605.67 crore, excluding matters where the financial impact cannot be quantified.

Strong BFSI stocks help indices offset IT weakness

Madhu Balaji
Bengaluru

Dalal Street extended its winning streak to a fifth consecutive session on Thursday as late buying in banking and financial stocks helped benchmark indices overcome weakness in IT stocks. Lower crude oil prices and optimism surrounding the India-UK FTA supported sentiment, while IT stocks remained under pressure after the US Federal Reserve's hawkish remarks, with investors watching for Accenture Q3 results.

The Sensex rose 254.36

points to close at 77,409.98, while the Nifty 50 gained 82.30 points to settle at 24,168. Bank Nifty advanced 0.66 per cent to close at 57,963.80, while PSU banks, private banks and financial indices also ended higher.

Among the Nifty 50 constituents, Max Healthcare, IndiGo, Adani Enterprises, Trent, Bharat Electronics, HDFC Bank and SBI led the gainers. On the losing side were Infosys, Tata Consumer Products, Tech Mahindra and TCS. Among banking counters, HDFC Bank, SBI, Yes Bank, Union Bank and IDFC First Bank led the gains.

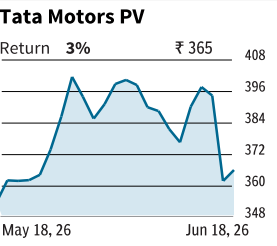
Tata Motors PV stock in focus after JLR's FY27 outlook; brokerages divided

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Shares of Tata Motors Passenger Vehicles (TMPV) remained in focus on Thursday, as brokerages offered mixed views on the company following Jaguar Land Rover's (JLR) investor day and its FY27 guidance.

The stock closed 1 per cent higher at ₹364.65 on the NSE after touching an intra-day high of ₹366.25.

The counter had come under significant pressure in the previous session, falling more than 8 per cent to



₹360.95 after investors reacted to JLR's outlook.

JLR unveiled a £1.7-billion profitability programme and outlined its FY27 growth strategy, banking on brands such as Defender, Range Rover and the new Jaguar, alongside a stronger focus on North America, to drive its

next phase of growth.

MIXED REACTION

Brokerages were divided on the implications of the guidance. Jefferies maintained its 'Underperform' rating on the stock with a target price of ₹300, citing subdued FY27 guidance from JLR, while BofA also maintained an 'Underperform' rating with a target price of ₹335. Citi retained its 'Sell' rating and cut its target price to ₹320 from ₹330, describing the FY27 guidance as cautious.

On the other hand, CLSA, Nuvama Institutional Equities and YES Securities were bullish about the stock.

BROKER'S CALL.

Motilal Oswal Research

COFORGE (BUY)

Target: ₹1,900

CMP: ₹1,482.40

We attended Coforge's Analyst Day, where discussions were centered on the company's medium-term growth aspirations, margin outlook following the Encora acquisition, evolving commercial models and the role of AI across its key verticals. The management outlined its ambition to scale up revenue from about \$2.5 billion currently to about \$5 billion by FY30, implying a revenue CAGR of about 19 per cent (about 15 per cent organic), supported by deeper penetration within existing verticals, increasing wallet share in large accounts, sustained large-deal momentum and selective acquisitions. The company also indicated that its margin profile has structurally improved, with portfolio rationalisation, acquisition integration and productivity initiatives supporting margins at levels above historical averages.

We came away with the view that Coforge is attempting to evolve beyond a purely volume-led growth model. The management increasingly emphasised domain-led transformation programmes, outcome-oriented commercial structures and larger, proactive engagements across key verticals such as Banking (29 per cent of revenue) and Travel (25 per cent of revenue). While the medium-term ambition appears achievable given the company's execution track record, sustained delivery will depend on successful large-deal conversion, integration of acquisitions and continued monetisation of AI-led opportunities. We value Coforge at 26x FY28E EPS with a TP of ₹1,900, implying a 30 per cent potential upside. Reiterate BUY.

Anand Rath Research

RATEGAIN TRAVEL TECHNOLOGIES (BUY)

Target: ₹1,000

CMP: ₹89.30

RateGain Travel Technologies reported organic revenue growth of about 8.8 per cent in rupee terms (about 4 per cent year on year in dollar terms) in FY26. It reported a 25.7 per cent year-on-year increase in deal-wins in FY26, which excludes deal-wins from Sojern, despite Sojern being integrated for five months in the fiscal. The deal pipeline also rose about 14 per cent despite about 25.7 per cent growth in deal-wins, suggesting strong deal momentum, going forward. We believe the deal win momentum is led by multiple product launches over the last 12 months and higher GTM spends (\$5 million). There is an opportunity to cross-sell Sojern's offerings to RateGain's existing customers. RateGain maintained a net cash position up to FY25. That said, it funded its acquisition of Sojern partially by way of borrowings (50 per cent of total consideration of \$250 million) resulting in a net debt position in FY26. However, with limited capex required owing to its SaaS model, we expect the company's FCF to increase, going forward, led by improving margin and consolidation of Sojern. We expect the company to return to a net cash position in FY28e. Even after recent run-up, we believe the stock is still trading at attractive valuations of 34.2/26.7x FY27/28e EPS. Thus, we continue to maintain Buy rating on the stock with an upwardly revised TP of ₹1,000 (from ₹875 earlier), valuing it at 30x FY28e EPS (vs 26x previously).

businessline is not responsible for the recommendations sourced from third party brokerages. Reports may be sent to: blmarketwatch@gmail.com

TODAY'S PICK.

Oberoai Realty (₹1,693.50): BUY

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

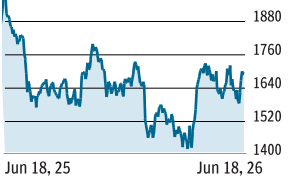
The stock of Oberoi Realty formed a good base at ₹1,400 in March and rebounded. But since mid-March, the trend has largely been flat where the price is oscillating between the broad ₹1,600-1,750 range.

Moreover, the price action shows that the stock is getting good buying interest so far this week. Therefore, we expect the stock to break out of ₹1,750 soon. Once this occurs, the stock can rally to ₹2,000 in the medium term.

Traders can consider buying

Oberoai Realty

Return -11%



the stock now at ₹1,693 and accumulate if the price dips to ₹1,620. Place initial stop-loss at ₹1,550. When the stock rises to ₹1,800 and ₹1,900, raise the stop-loss to ₹1,720 and ₹1,850 respectively. Book profits at ₹2,000.

Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis. There is a risk of loss in trading

Day trading guide

24209 » Nifty 50 Futures					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
24050	23900	24300	24500	Buy when the contracts dips to 24120; stop-loss can be 24050.	
₹798 » HDFC Bank					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
790	780	800	820	The stock is likely to extend the rally; buy with stop-loss at 780.	
₹1127 » Infosys					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1125	1110	1150	1160	Hovering near a support; initiate longs with a stop-loss at 1110.	
₹291 » ITC					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
288	285	294	300	The price action hints at a rally; go long with a stop-loss at 288.	
₹245 » ONGC					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
243	240	248	250	Stock has formed a base and can rally; buy with stop-loss at 243.	
₹1327 » Reliance Ind.					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1320	1305	1350	1370	Stock set to rally; consider fresh longs with stop-loss at 1305.	
₹1042 » SBI					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1035	1020	1050	1065	Intraday outlook is bullish; buy at 1035 with stop-loss at 1020.	
₹2204 » TCS					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
2180	2135	2230	2270	The stock shows signs of a rally; go long with a stop-loss at 2180.	

S1, S2: Support 1 & 2; R1, R2: Resistance 1 & 2.

SEBI proposes changes to Margin Trading Facility framework

Our Bureau
Mumbai



The regulator has proposed allowing brokers to accept all collateral eligible in the normal cash market for MTF transactions

SEBI on Thursday proposed a series of changes to the Margin Trading Facility (MTF) framework, including allowing brokers to raise funds through non-convertible debentures (NCDs), increasing the minimum net worth required to offer MTF to ₹5 crore, and easing operational requirements for brokers while retaining key risk safeguards.

The MTF framework was introduced in 2004 and last underwent a comprehensive review in 2017.

"The proposals seek to enhance operational efficiency and ease of doing business for stock brokers, and to strengthen the calibration of risk and margining in the MTF segment," SEBI said.

The market regulator has suggested expanding the sources of funds available to brokers by permitting borrowing through NCDs and other debt instruments in addition to existing sources. It has also proposed raising the minimum net worth requirement for brokers offering MTF from ₹3 crore to ₹5 crore, while allowing Limited Liability Partnerships (LLPs) to provide the facility.

SEBI has proposed a revised exposure framework, under which brokers would be required to ring-fence a portion of their net worth for their core broking business, while permitting the remaining net worth to be used for MTF within an overall exposure limit of 5.5 times their net worth.

The regulator has also proposed allowing brokers to accept all collateral eligible in the normal cash market for MTF transactions and permit early pay-in

OTHER PROPOSALS

To address situations where an eligible security is downgraded or shifted out of the Group I category, SEBI has proposed providing brokers a 30-day rebalancing window to comply with regulatory requirements instead of requiring immediate adjustments.

SEBI has suggested a uniform Rights and Obligations document across stock exchanges, revised reporting timelines for brokers, fungibility between normal and MTF client ledgers and a mechanism to treat certain breaches of client-level exposure limits as "passive breaches", subject to rectification within 30 days.

The regulator has, however, decided against reducing the higher maintenance margin applicable when client cash collateral is used for pay-in and the purchased security itself serves as collateral.

Accordingly, it has proposed retaining the higher maintenance margin requirement of value at risk plus five times the extreme loss margin for such transactions.

Nifty 50 Movers					
	Close(%)	Pts	PE	WN(%)	
HDFC Bank	799.00	39.77	15.52	11.05	
State Bank	1042.70	14.68	11.11	3.91	
Max Healthcare	1090.45	10.45	73.57	0.73	
ICI Bank	1342.30	8.59	16.59	8.67	
Bharat Elec	428.60	6.84	51.68	1.39	
NTPC	361.95	6.63	12.74	1.55	
IntGlobeAwi	5011.80	6.59	0.00	1.02	
Avis Bank	1360.10	5.76	15.92	3.53	
Trent Ltd.	3179.70	5.59	98.50	0.96	
Hind Unilever	2218.50	4.05	49.26	1.78	
Adani Enter	3013.40	3.85	39.12	0.78	
Eicher Motors	7601.00	2.76	37.81	0.95	
Tata Steel	200.52	2.73	23.00	1.50	
PowerGrid Corp	288.70	2.32	16.86	1.13	
HDFC Life	591.30	2.23	66.71	0.57	
Adani Ports	1842.10	2.17	33.20	1.23	
Tata Motors PV	364.65	1.69	4476.23	0.69	
Bajaj Finserv	2773.70	1.68	60.13	1.13	
UltraTech Cement	1439.00	1.47	41.13	1.22	
JSW Steel	1293.90	1.37	12.40	1.10	
SBI Life	1807.60	1.37	73.39	0.73	
Sun Pharma	1524.80	1.02	38.04	1.75	
Bajaj Auto	1771.70	0.89	14.42	0.93	
Bajaj Finance	10077.00	0.85	26.63	1.01	
Jio Financial Services Ltd.	291.15	0.84	17.36	2.54	
ONGC	244.10	0.80	99.35	0.72	
MM	3136.50	0.70	20.95	2.53	
Titan	4387.80	0.67	76.77	1.64	
Cipla	1355.50	0.58	28.35	0.69	
Bajaj Finance	958.85	0.26	30.86	2.32	
ONGC	245.30	0.25	6.20	0.86	
MM	3136.50	0.24	20.95	2.53	
Eluminal Ltd.	134.97	-2.58	6.85	1.77	
Hindalco	1008.50	-0.19	16.92	1.32	
Dr Reddys Lab	1267.50	-0.20	25.45	0.70	
Apollo Hosp	8411.50	-0.36	60.39	0.78	
Grassim Ind	3145.10	-0.44	20.78	1.08	
Shanti Airtel	124.97	-0.18	3.23	5.29	
Wipro	182.84	-1.02	14.46	0.47	
NestleIndia	1400.40	-1.08	77.17	0.91	
HCL Tech	1161.80	-1.15	18.93	1.11	
Shriram Finance Ltd.	1002.70	-1.47	23.53	1.27	
Coal India	452.80	-1.86	8.97	0.93	
TataConsumerProduct	1111.40	-1.86	71.10	0.65	
Tech Mahindra	1447.70	-2.04	29.52	0.83	
Kotak Bank	402.95	-2.49	20.78	2.68	
Maruti Suzuki	13484.00	-4.18	28.88	1.60	
TCS	2203.20	-4.35	16.12	2.03	
L&T	4190.00	-4.54	30.41	4.45	
Reliance Ind	1328.10	-6.78	18.77	8.11	
Infosys	1127.50	-23.12	15.51	3.57	

Pts: Impact on index movement

Nifty Next 50 Movers					▲ 337.45 pts.
	Close(%)	Pts	PE	WN(%)	
Adani Power	209.57	118.59	34.28	3.72	
AdaniGreenenergy	1506.80	38.88	124.91	1.97	
Divis Lab	6767.00	37.21	69.95	3.35	
United Spirits	1350.30	35.34	52.61	1.35	
Adani Energy Solutions .	1523.30	31.70	76.48	2.06	
DF	640.70	31.12	35.92	1.60	
Indian Hotels Co.	710.45	28.19	45.00	2.43	
Tata Motors Cy	407.05	25.13	49.50	3.31	
Bajaj Holdings	10676.00	21.55	12.14	1.80	
Solar Industries	17764.00	21.16	92.58	1.69	
Bosch	40035.00	19.75	42.58	1.35	
Shree Cement	25410.00	16.65	52.43	1.32	
Union Bank	176.12	12.95	6.92	1.23	
Chowdaram&Fin	1688.90	11.75	27.49	2.82	
Gail (India)	176.44	10.76	15.30	1.85	
Tata Capital	345.45	10.00	29.98	0.58	
Hdfc Amb	278.20	9.86	40.89	2.17	
Abb India	722.09	9.64	96.95	1.48	
Cummins India	5858.00	9.55	68.76	3.08	
Zydus Lifesciences	107.64	9.20	29.98	1.05	
Avenue Supermarts	4306.70	8.60	94.37	2.47	
Macrotech Developers .	924.00	7.33	26.90	1.01	
Indian Oilcorp	146.11	7.29	4.72	2.13	
Punjab Natl Bank	109.58	6.93	6.82	1.47	
Tata Power	402.90	6.63	25.16	2.63	
Axis Bank	403.60	6.12	33.92	1.02	
Bank Of Baroda	283.00	6.04	7.29	2.05	
Tvs Motor Corp	3457.60	5.91	51.55	3.16	
Indian Rail and Steel	24.36	5.53	0.00	0.16	
Siemens	3746.20	5.20	87.04	1.29	
Britannia Ind	5245.00	4.33	49.80	2.41	
Pidilite Ind	158.10	2.54	45.13	1.31	
Terrell Pharma	444.55	0.80	70.37	1.81	
Ltintindree	3998.00	0.58	23.79	1.45	
Hyundai Motor India .	197.60	-0.04	29.57	1.10	
Rural Elec	358.70	-0.18	5.77	0.08	
Siemens Energy India	3783.40	-0.45	102.87	3.30	
Hinduja Zc	571.45	-1.35	17.46	0.67	
Indian Railway Finance Corp	100.13	-1.76	18.67	0.78	
Vedanta	306.00	-2.40	7.55	0.23	
Muthofin	3182.40	-2.49	12.05	1.33	
Canara Bank	134.97	-2.58	6.85	1.77	
Saamraam Dock	2533.90	-3.98	37.09	0.75	
India Steel	111.94	-4.09	11.54	0.25	
Mazda Motors&Internatl	144.68	-5.26	37.38	2.50	
Vedanta Oil & Gas	31.32	-6.10	0.00	0.21	
Vedanta Power	40.53	-7.07	0.00	0.27	
Bpcl	316.30	-9.46	53.31	2.56	
Power Finance	429.39	-10.09	4.21	2.44	
Good Consumer	100.00	-12.25	54.34	2.55	
Cg Power & Ind Sol	95.44	-18.05	125.61	2.55	
HindustanAeronautics	44.11	-26.30	32.37	3.26	
Varun Beverages .	531.55	-48.39	56.02	2.83	
Vedanta Aluminium	44.08	-83.06	0.00	2.97	

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Following the investment via preferential allotment of equity shares, Emirates NBD Bank (PJSC) has a 60 per cent stake in RBL Bank. It has been classified as a promoter of the bank.

Further, RBL Bank's board has been re-constituted, with Emirates NBD Bank nominating its top executives to five board positions as (Additional) Non-Executive, Non-Independent Directors — Shayne Keith Nelson, Group Chief Executive Officer; Patrick John Sullivan, Group Chief Financial Officer; Neeraj Makin, Group Head of Strategy, Analytics and Venture Capital; Manoj Chawla, Group Chief Risk Officer; and Marwan

Our Bureau
Mumbai

SBI plans to raise up to ₹60,000 crore during the financial year 2026-27. The funds may be mobilised in rupees or any other convertible currency through the issuance of various debt instruments, long-term bonds, Basel III-compliant additional tier 1 bonds, and tier 2 bonds.

The fundraising will be carried out through public offerings or private placements and will target both domestic and international investors.

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

The working group, chaired by Prof Sandeep K Shukla, Director, IIIT-Hyderabad, will provide direction on governance frameworks, best

In the recent past, rapid advancements in emerging technologies such as AI have begun to reshape the cybersecurity threat landscape as these technologies find increasing adoption within the insurance sector and they may pose challenges for regulated entities.

It also proposes to issue the IRDAI (Procedure for Making Regulations and Subsidiary In-

In an exposure draft, IRDAI has prescribed broad principles that may be considered while framing regulations, including a public consultation framework, a framework for economic analysis, and empower the authority to undertake economic analysis of proposed regulations, includ-

The proposed regulations provide for consultation with the Insurance Advisory Committee in accordance with the provisions of the IRDA Act, 1999, and also empower the authority to establish additional consultation mechanisms that incorporate domain expertise to examine the regulatory proposals, as per the circular.


TATA POWER
(Corporate Contracts Department)
The Tata Power Company Limited, 2nd Floor, Sakshi Receiving Station
Sahar Airport Road, Andheri East, Mumbai-400052
(Board Line: 022-67173917) CIN: L28920MH1919PLC000567

NOTICE INVITING TENDER (NIT)

The Tata Power Company Limited invites tenders from eligible vendors for the following packages (Two Part Bidding) in Mumbai.

A) 220KV Cable trench from Tower 177 to 177B at 110KV Kalwa - Kalyan line at Paradise, Dombivli east (Package Reference No. **CC26B012**)

B) Replacement of Precast cover and other fabrication works at Trombay RSS (**Package Reference No. CC27S0B11**).

C) SITC of passenger lifts at Tata Power Powai RSS (2 Nos) and Saki RSS (01 No), Mumbai (**Package Reference No. CC26SVP009**).

For package A, B & C interested bidders to submit Tender Fee and Authorization Letter up to **1500 Hrs. Monday, 29th June 2026**

For detailed NIT and Tender documents, please visit tender section on website <https://www.tatapower.com>. All future corrigendum's (if any), to the subject tender shall be communicated on Tender section of website <https://www.tatapower.com> only.

 **PAGE INDUSTRIES LIMITED**

Registered Office: 7th Floor, Umiya Business Bay-Tower-1, Cessna Business Park, Varthur Hobli,
Outer Ring Road, Bengaluru - 560 103. Ph: 080 - 4945 4545,
www.pageind.com | investors@jockeyindia.com | CIN#: L18101KA1994PLC016554

**NOTICE OF 31ST ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING THROUGH
VIDEO CONFERENCE ("VC") / OTHER AUDIO VISUAL MEANS ("OAVM")**

Notice is hereby given that the 31st Annual General Meeting of the Company ("AGM") will be convened on Thursday, 13 August 2026 at 11:30 AM IST through Video Conference ("VC")/ Other Audio Visual Means ("OAVM") facility in compliance with the applicable provisions of the Companies Act, 2013 and Rules framed thereunder and the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 read with General Circular No. 03/2025 dated 22 September 2025 issued by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs, without the physical presence of the Members at a common venue. The deemed venue for the 31st AGM shall be the Registered Office of the Company.

The Notice of the 31st AGM and the Annual Report for the year 2025-26 including the financial statements for the year ended 31 March 2026 will be sent only by email to all those Members, whose email addresses are registered with the Company or with their respective Depository Participants ("Depository"), in accordance with the MCA Circular/s and the SEBI Circular. Members can join and participate in the 31st AGM through VC/ OAVM facility only. The instructions for joining the 31st AGM and the manner of participation in the remote electronic voting or casting vote through the e-voting system during the 31st AGM will be provided in the Notice of the 31st AGM. Members participating through the VC/OAVM facility shall be counted for the purpose of reckoning the quorum under Section 103 of the Companies Act, 2013. The Notice of the 31st AGM and the Annual Report will also be available on the website of the Company i.e. www.pageind.com and the website of stock exchanges i.e. www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com.

Members holding shares in Physical form can send a request to the Registrar and Transfer Agents of the Company (RTA), at rnt.helpdesk@in.mpmns.mufg.com providing Folio No., Name of shareholder, scanned copy of the share certificate (front and back), PAN (self attested scanned copy of PAN card), AADHAR (self attested scanned copy of Aadhar Card) for registering email address. Members holding shares in demat form can update their email address with their Depository Participant.

Bank details update for Electronic Clearing System (ECS): Members are requested to update changes, if any, pertaining to bank details such as, name of the bank and branch details, bank account number, MICR code, IFSC code, etc., to their DPs in case the shares are held by them in electronic form and to Registrars and Share Transfer Agent (RTA) MUGF Intime India Pvt Ltd, C-101, 247 Park, L B S Marg, Vikhroli West, Mumbai - 400083. Tel No: 022 49186000 Fax: 022 49186060. Email: rnt.helpdesk@in.mpmns.mufg.com in case the shares are held by them in physical form, for physical form send request letter to RTA for update along with cancelled cheque leaf.

For Page Industries Limited
Murugesh C.
Company Secretary

Place: Bengaluru
Date: 16 June 2026

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BENGALURU - 2026

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Associate Partners

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QUICKLY.

Airtel veteran Rahul Vatts appointed COAI Chairman

New Delhi: Telecom service providers (TSPs) industry body, the Cellular Operators Association of India (COAI), on Thursday, appointed Rahul Vatts, Group Chief Regulatory Officer and Director - Corporate Affairs, Bharti Airtel, as Chairperson and Ravi P Gandhi, Chief Regulatory Officer, Reliance Jio Infocomm, as Vice-Chairperson for 2026-27. The decision was made in its annual general body meeting for the financial year 2025-26, which brought together COAI members to review key developments in the sector. **OUR BUREAU**

ADIA, others buy 7.3% stake in Corona Remedies

New Delhi: Foreign investors led by Abu Dhabi Investment Authority (ADIA), Aberdeen Group and Factory Mutual Insurance Company bought a combined 7.3 per cent stake in Corona Remedies for ₹777 crore through open market transactions. Domestic mutual firms also participated in the transaction. **■**

Wipro to buy 20% stake in Aggne Global for ₹20 cr



New Delhi: IT services major Wipro on Thursday said it will acquire an additional 20 per cent stake in Aggne Global IT Services for ₹19.8 crore. Following the latest transaction, Wipro's overall shareholding in Aggne Global IT will increase to 80 per cent, the company said in a regulatory filing. **■**

Pradhan stresses on transparency, integrity ahead of NEET-UG re-exam

GEARING UP. Education Minister instructs officials to facilitate a stress-free environment for students

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan on Thursday chaired a high-level review meeting of senior officials from Education Ministry, State governments, National Testing Agency (NTA) and higher education institutions to assess the preparedness of the NEET UG re-examination scheduled to be conducted on June 21. Addressing the meeting, Pradhan emphasised on the importance of maintaining the “highest standards of integrity, transparency and efficiency” in the examination process and directed all concerned authorities to remain vigilant and fully prepared for the free and fair conduct of the re-examination.



DETAILED DELIBERATIONS. Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan chairing a meeting to assess preparedness for the NEET UG re-examination in New Delhi. **■**

He said that the officers designated by the ministry will reach all the States to co-ordinate the activities pertaining to the re-examination process. They will report to the Command Centre headed by the DG, NTA. He asked the designated nodal officers of the State governments to ensure that students were provided all necessary facilities to enable them to appear for the

re-examination in a stress-free environment.

STRICT COMPLIANCE In the review meeting, Sanjay Kumar, Secretary, Department of School Education and Literacy, said that the nodal officers of the State governments are to ensure that adequate steps are taken to ensure students are provided with all the necessary facilities and are put at

ease. Vineet Joshi, Secretary, Department of Higher Education, stressed on the need for proactive coordination, timely dissemination of instructions and strict compliance with all prescribed protocols. Meanwhile, Abhishek Singh, Director General, NTA, said the NTA was working with all concerned stakeholders, including the district-level coordination committees headed by the DMs, State police departments and intelligence agencies, to ensure that the re-examination was conducted smoothly.

FAIR EXAM “Detailed deliberations were held on the examination preparedness, coordination mechanisms, security protocols, logistical arrangements, grievance redressal

mechanisms and adherence to examination guidelines. States/UTs were advised to maintain close coordination with all stakeholders to ensure the smooth, transparent and seamless conduct of the re-examination,” an official statement added. In a social media post on X, NTA assured students that extensive arrangements are in place for a safe, secure and fair examination, which will be conducted as scheduled. “Please do not be swayed by rumours of postponement or by the noise on social media. Rely only on official communication from NTA... The integrity of this process is our highest priority, and robust, multi-layered safeguards have been put in place. Any attempt at malpractice will be dealt with firmly,” the post stated.

Lufthansa eyes higher traffic from India after Germany scraps airport transit visa requirement

Rohit Vaid
New Delhi

The Lufthansa Group expects the recent removal of airport transit visa requirements for Indian nationals connecting through German airports to improve passenger flows from India, particularly on routes to the UK and several long-haul destinations. Speaking to *businessline*, Kevin Markette, Senior Director-Regional Sales, South Asia, Lufthansa Group, said the policy change removes a long-standing friction point



for Indian travellers transiting through Germany. The move, he cited, could encourage a greater number of passengers to opt for one-stop connections via its

Frankfurt and Munich stops. The senior executive said that while the change may not fundamentally alter underlying travel patterns, it is expected to strengthen demand on sectors where Lufthansa has a significant network advantage, particularly the UK and certain destinations in Central and South America.

KEY MARKETS “The UK is clearly one of the key markets that will benefit from this development, alongside other long-haul destinations, including markets in Central and South

America such as Brazil,” he said. The development assumes significance as European carriers intensify competition for Indian outbound traffic. Lufthansa group currently operates more than 70 weekly flights from India, including over 50 services to Germany, providing onward connectivity to over 200 destinations through its Frankfurt and Munich hubs. **MORE SERVICES** The airline group also described India as its largest market in the Asia-Pacific region and its second-largest

intercontinental market globally after the US. According to Markette, Lufthansa has recently added frequencies to India following the redeployment of aircraft from West Asia during the first quarter of 2026 and continues to evaluate opportunities for further growth in the market. The airline is also increasing capacity deployment on India routes, including the introduction of Airbus A380 operations on Mumbai-Munich services, making Mumbai the second Indian city after Delhi to receive regular A380 operations.

Zee 5 commits 15% subscription revenues for Indian football

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Zee Entertainment Enterprises will dedicate 15 per cent of its football-related OTT subscription revenues towards building football in India following its partnership with FIFA. After bagging multiple broadcasting rights for various FIFA properties including the ongoing 2026 World Cup, Zee said it will work with the football federation to boost talent discovery and development, building league ecosystems and enabling resources for players as well as coaches in India. “Fifteen per cent of Zee S’s football-related subscription revenues will be contributed towards building football in India. The company’s partnership with FIFA until 2034, reflects its commitment to elevate the development of football as a sport,” said Zee in a press release.



FOR GRASSROOTS. Zee said it will work with the football federation to boost talent discovery and development

KEY PROPOSALS Zee will help in terms of structured training initiatives and create scalable league formats at the city, district, State and national level. To further support the development initiatives, Zee will on-board renowned football personalities as domain experts to help build a conducive ecosystem in India. It will also collaborate with other key sporting federations globally and na-

tional- and State-level associations to define action-oriented steps for talent identification and training. Punit Goenka, CEO, Zee Entertainment Enterprises, said, “Through this initiative, we are enabling our football viewers to invest in the dreams of countless young Indians who aspire to play at a global stage. Our efforts aim to blend passion with opportunity and translate engagement into impact.”

Ban on Telegram was very much justifiable, Centre’s counsel tells Delhi High Court

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

Counsel representing the Centre on Thursday told the Delhi High Court that the ban on Telegram was very much justifiable because lakhs of students are impacted, and it was not a permanent blocking of the app, but just for a few days, till the NEET-UG 2026 re-examination. The Centre vehemently argued before the High Court that Telegram has all the potential of getting misused by miscreants. Justice Tejas Karia has reserved the verdict after hearing extensive arguments from Senior Advocate Dhruv Mehta, appearing for Telegram, and Attorney General R Venkataramani and Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, who represented the Centre. The judge also asked the counsel for both parties to file their written submissions, if any, by late evening Thursday. The Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY), acting on recommendations of the National Testing Agency (NTA), issued a direction under Section 69A of the Information Technology Act, 2000, restricting access to the Telegram platform in India till June 22. **RIGHTS OF 150 MILLION** MeitY, in its submission, said that it had been receiving several complaints about misuse of Telegram as a platform. The first such com-



plaint came from the NTA, which was dated May 21. Meanwhile, the Court also questioned the Centre’s decision to temporarily restrict access to Telegram, saying how the rights of over 150 million users of the messaging app can be curtailed just because a few of them are taking up the test. “How can we stop the rights of 150 million people just because one set of citizens are appearing in examinations... The question is, can you block somebody else’s rights to protect someone else’s rights? The law has been laid down in the Anuradha Bhasin case (judgment),” the Bench asked. The law officer said that the apex court judgment in the Anuradha Bhasin case does not prohibit blocking. Solicitor General Tushar Mehta who represented the Centre referred to the technical aspects of the messaging app and said that a single Telegram account can create up to 40 bots. “I will just give an example. In Telegram, one account user can create 40 bots. While in case of WhatsApp, it’s one bot per user,” he said. **DESIGN ISSUE** He argued bots are machines and they can further multiply and as per the report, Telegram can offer bot infrastructure, which can disseminate information in bulk. Justifying the decision, Mehta said the government does not have this problem with other intermediaries. “This platform operates through the cloud. Even if they block it and someone does mischief, law enforcement agencies cannot reach the actual user,” he said. He also mentioned that the report indicated that Telegram is frequently used for terrorist activities and that law enforcement agencies face challenges due to this.

NAN GreenMet, Silox in JV for battery recycling

Our Bureau
Mumbai

NAN GreenMet, the advanced manufacturing platform founded by Navin Agarwal, Vice-Chairman of Vedanta, has formed a joint venture with Silox, the Belgium-headquartered global leader in hydrometallurgical processing of non-ferrous metal residues. The JV company — NAN Silox GreenMet — will establish a Li-ion battery recycling and critical minerals recovery platform in Andhra Pradesh. It will develop and operate a facility to process spent battery through shredding, beneficiation and hydrometallurgical refining, enabling the recovery of strategic materials such as lithium, cobalt, nickel and manganese. It will explore downstream value creation, including cathode active materials and second-life battery applications for stationary energy storage systems.

Domain expertise, an asset in the AI-coding era

KV Kurmanath
Hyderabad

Here’s some good news for those who are overtly worried about the threat of being replaced by AI. A recent survey conducted by the AI company Anthropic has found that domain expertise has a clear edge. The more understanding a worker brings to an agent, the higher-quality work the agent can do. Agentic coding has arrived — from Microsoft to TCS, and even small start-ups have begun deploying Agents to handle a wide range of tasks. That the share of GitHub projects with coding agent activity has more than doubled since late 2025 reflects the sharp spurt in model-assisted coding. But here’s a catch. Knowing how to code doesn’t auto-



matically give one an edge in conducting successful coding development sessions on Claude Code, resulting in the development of agentic tools. It is the domain expertise of those who are interacting with the model which is the differentiator, according to the latest Anthropic study. **CODE SESSIONS** It studied over four lakh Claude Code sessions conducted by 2.35 lakh people between October 2025 and

The more understanding a worker brings to an agent, the higher-quality work the agent can do

April 2026, in which people make most of the planning decisions (what to do), and Claude makes most of the execution decisions (how to do it). “The greater domain expertise a person brings to a session, the more work Claude does per instruction. The more domain expertise a person has ... the more often the session ends in success,” the AI company said in its latest study. “Claude is handling more complex and more valuable

tasks. At the same time, there remains a clear division of labour in agentic coding,” it said. Paramdeep Singh, Co-Founder of Shorthills AI, likened the human-AI collaboration to directing a movie. “The human plays the director, giving instructions, while AI handles the actual execution, the acting. Anthropic’s study on AI-assisted coding reflects exactly this dynamic,” he said. “But when it comes to the product itself, it is the product manager, the person with domain expertise, who plays the director’s role and tells the AI exactly what needs to be done,” he added. The bigger takeaway from this study is that product managers and domain experts, people who can direct and guide what the machine does, are going to be in far greater demand.

Study finds 37% of entry-level tasks in India are already performed by AI

Our Bureau
Chennai

Artificial intelligence (AI) performs 37 per cent of entry-level tasks in India, a survey by Cognizant and Pearson has found. The study, titled *The AI Workforce Pulse: The Adaptability Imperative*, identifies that globally, AI task designation comes to 33 per cent, with 18 per cent of HR leaders claiming that half or more of entry-level work is handled by AI. This rate is higher than global average for India, indicating AI’s impact on India’s entry-level workforce, which seems to be higher than globally.

More than 90 per cent of all HR leaders and professionals worldwide expect entry-level positions to transform into those involving more management of AI systems within the next half-decade, thereby creating new entry-level roles. They also aspire to increase focus on AI skills for non-technical roles. However, these aspirations are not in line with preparedness of the organisations in AI training.

TRANSFORMING JOBS Around 63 per cent of Indian respondents say that their Learning & Development programmes cannot keep up with how quickly AI is transforming jobs. Eighty per cent of organisations in India re-

Around 63% of respondents said their learning and development programmes cannot keep up with how quickly AI is transforming jobs

port that AI is enabling employees to focus on higher-value work, signifying a rising shift towards more strategic responsibilities. Compared to the US (49 per cent), India fares better in learning, given how 63 per cent of Indian organisations

have allotted time for AI training. A total of 80 per cent of organisations in India report that AI is enabling employees to focus on higher-value work, signifying a rising shift towards more strategic responsibilities. Two in three HR professionals report they value liberal arts degrees more than they used to in light of AI advancements. Rajesh Varrier, President, Global Operations, and Chairman & MD, Cognizant India, said, “This shift underscores the necessity for extensive reskilling and improved managerial effectiveness, both of which are key in an economy increasingly shaped by AI.”



CBSE row: OSM tech supplier says no system breach found

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

Coempt Edu Teck, an educational technology solutions company that faced criticism over the CBSE On-Screen Marking (OSM) row, has reached out to its partner ecosystem, claiming that its technology is not at fault. Pushed to the wall by widespread criticism following a teenage hacker’s expose of the security breach, the company reached out to its clients to clear the air and assert that there was no problem with its technological solutions. Addressing concerns regarding blurred images and handwriting visibility, Coempt clarified that these cases are being systematically reviewed in coordination with relevant evaluation authorities. **INDUSTRY STANDARD** The company firmly denied allegations that tender conditions were altered to accommodate

substandard hardware. “The scanners used by Coempt are standard, industry-grade models utilised across the sector. We upgrade our hardware year-on-year, and the scanning resolution is perfect,” the company said in a press release. Security protocols also came under scrutiny after a 19-year-old ethical hacker claimed to have accessed parts of Coempt’s platform. “The server he managed to hack was a testing server, which is never used by any client. It’s used for internal purposes, including dummy tests, and it has public access. Coempt verified that no student data or technical infrastructure was compromised,” it said. Among the primary issues drawing public attention was an incident where a student reportedly received another candidate’s answer sheet. Coempt traced the matter directly to the physical scanning process rather than a software glitch.

